



Individual Instructor Report Fall 2023 Version B for STA 301 - INTRODUCTION TO DATA SCIENCE (05345) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Fall 2023**

Courses Audience: **59**

Responses Received: **19**

Response Ratio: **32.2%**

Report Comments

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

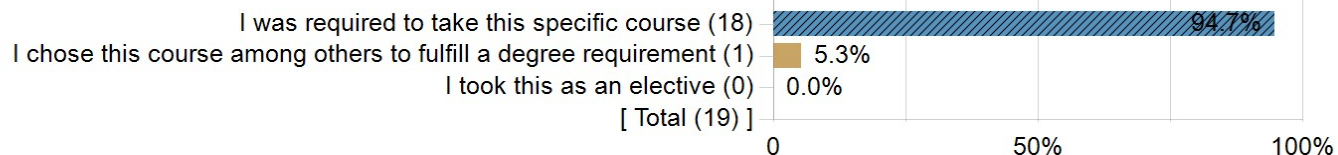
The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.

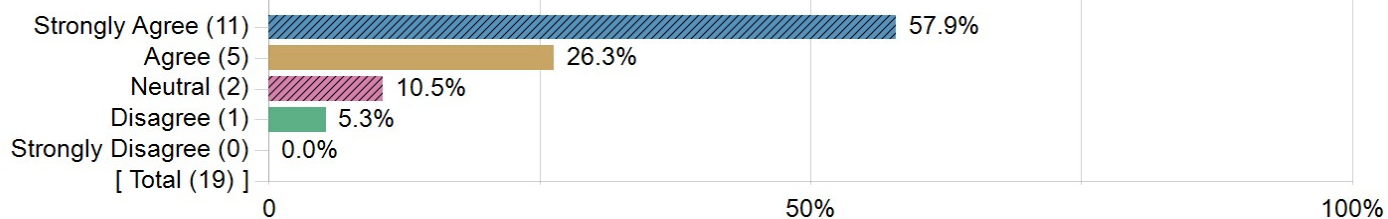
Creation Date: **Sunday, January 21, 2024**

Course Questions

Why did you take this course?

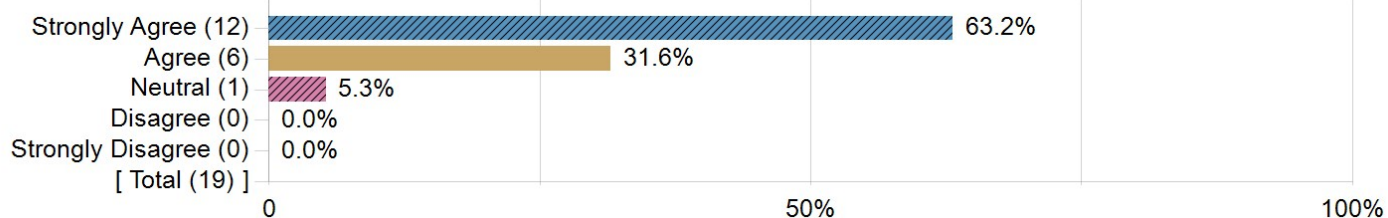


During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.



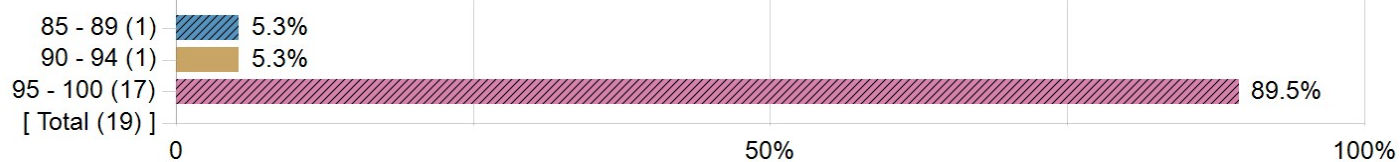
Statistics	Value
Mean	4.37

The course was well organized.



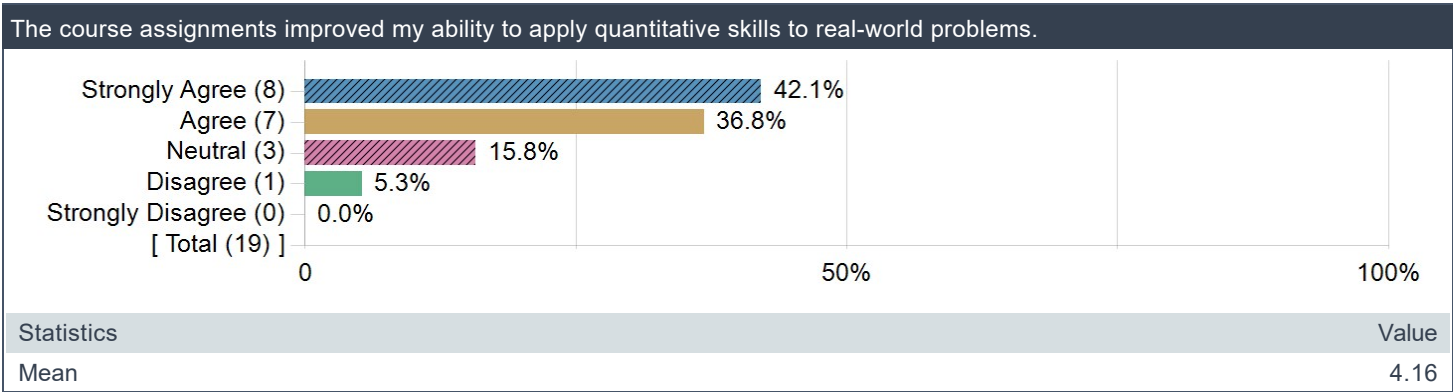
Statistics	Value
Mean	4.58

Overall, approximately what percentage of the course meetings did you attend or complete (online, in person, or asynchronously)?



Statistics	Value
Mean	97.89

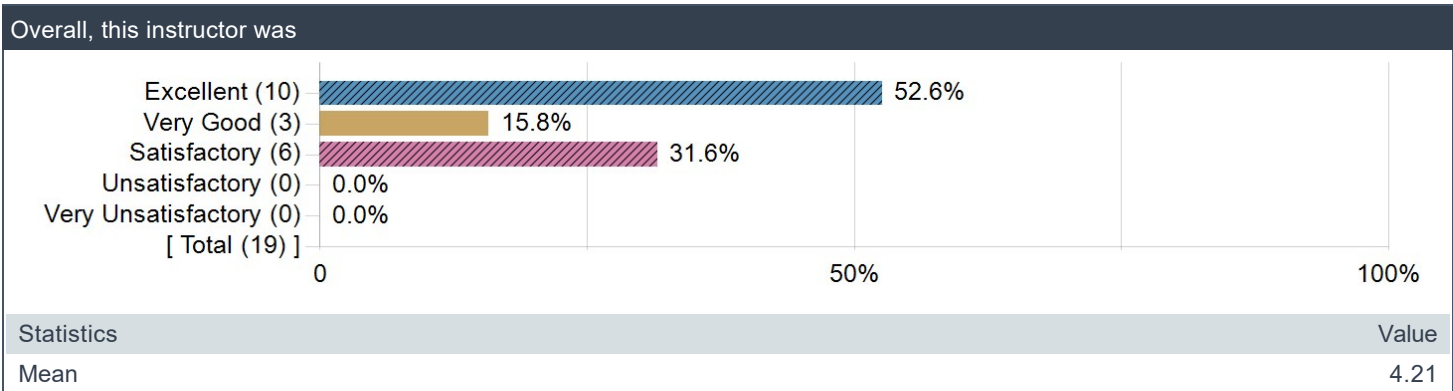
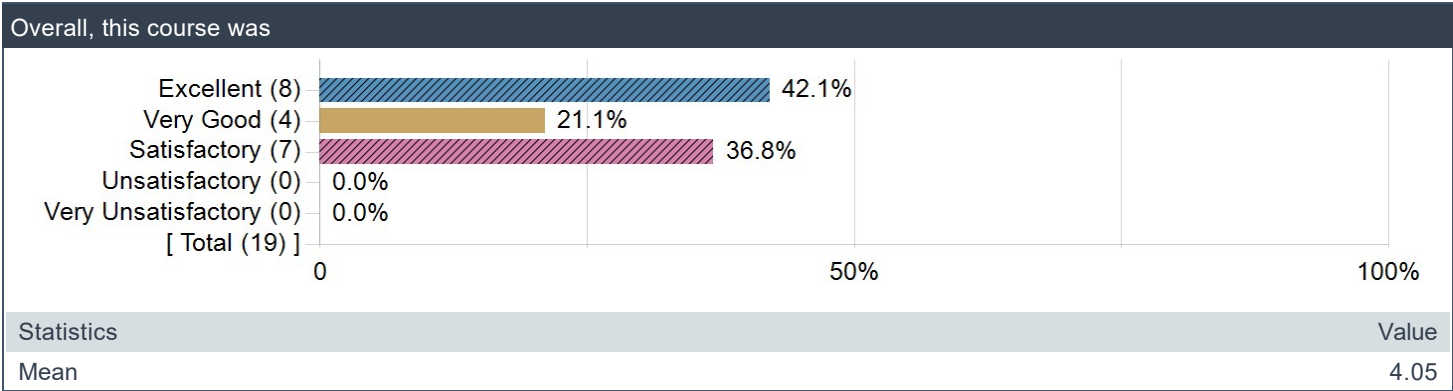
The course assignments improved my ability to apply quantitative skills to real-world problems. (Flag Question)



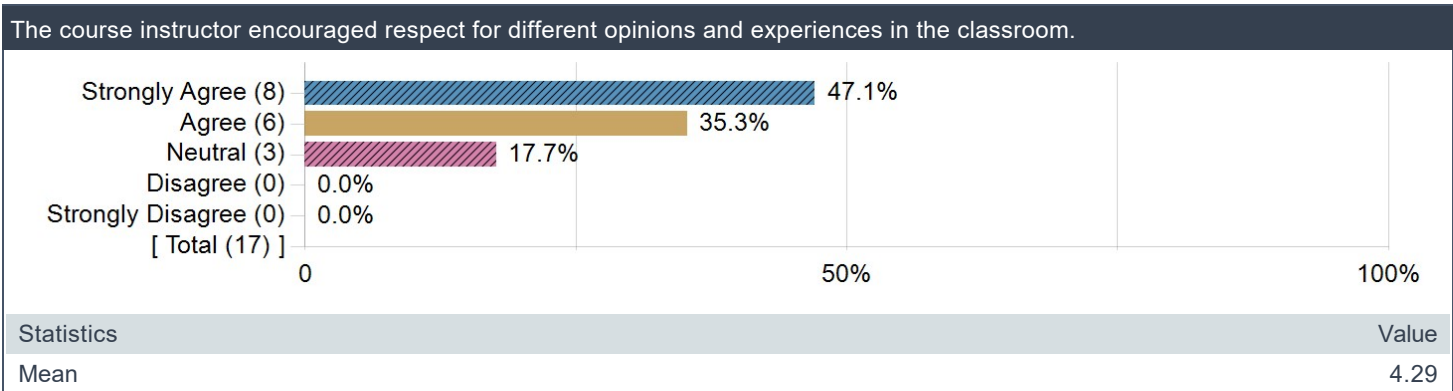
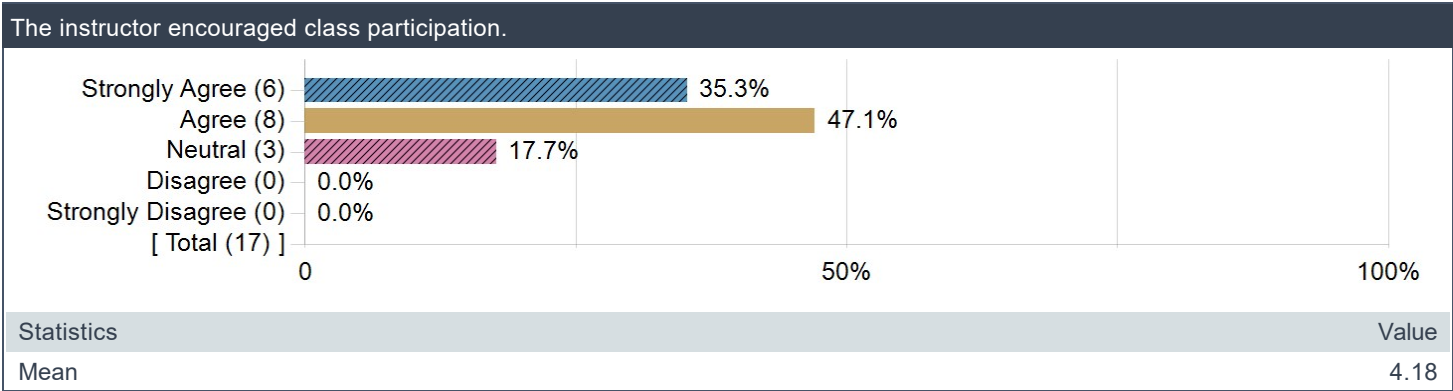
Instructor Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	57.9%	21.1%	21.1%	0.0%	0.0%	19	4.37
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	52.6%	31.6%	15.8%	0.0%	0.0%	19	4.37
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	52.6%	10.5%	31.6%	5.3%	0.0%	19	4.11
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	52.6%	5.3%	31.6%	10.5%	0.0%	19	4.00
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	52.6%	15.8%	26.3%	5.3%	0.0%	19	4.16

Overall Questions



College, School, or Unit Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comments
Class examples and the textbook
NA
Very effective course well organized and explained.
The most effective part of this class was working in R Studio during class. Instead of lecturing, it was hands-on so that we could do it on our own.
I think that the professor was engaging and funny as well, which helped me stay engaged in my learning!
The professor is pretty funny, he went slowly and made sure everyone understood the concepts.
The homework's
office hours
Knowledge Checks
The most effective part of Bolfarine' s lectures were how he explained everything and how he was constantly asking if anyone had questions
Knowledge Checks
When working in R-studio, it was very helpful that my professor wrote lots of side notes that explained what certain codes meant or what questions where aksing.
The lectures and Rscripts. Dr. Bolfarine was a great professor and would go over everything we needed to know in the lectures and was always willing to help us.
The TA office hours helped my learning immensely.

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comments
Understanding the concepts in the fast pace class
NA
Exams are challenging based on a short time period/many questions.
The most challenging aspect was that the professor was hard to follow and repetitive in class. He didn't effectively communicate the topics in a way that all students could understand so it was hard to stay focused when you already didn't understand.
Towards the end of the course, the content was dense and more difficult to understand. I think that more time needed to be spent on the topics covered later in the class. I struggled towards the end.
The content itself, but it was very learnable. Just do your work every day.
The lectures themselves sometimes did not explain the material well and let students stranded. Some of the knowledge checks were confusing too.
homeworks
Homeworks are difficult
The most challenging part of the lectures was the speed of the lectures.
Homework assignments were very difficult to work with as they would be very different from the examples we did in class.
I struggled on understanding certain concepts, but going to office hours for help was always very helpful.
None
An aspect of the course I found most challenging was the conceptual part of statistics. I prefer the solving side of statistics over the concepts. I would say maybe only having one KC per week. Two KCs a week was rather difficult to keep up with.